



Robot feeding arm

Arm-A-Dine is a robotic arm that is mounted on your chest to feed you food when you are too full to move. <https://digit.in/dec18-124-1>



Guitendo hero!

The Guitendo guitar is made from the traditional Nintendo console, NES. Both are functioning! <https://digit.in/dec18-124-2>

THE EVOLUTION OF FAKE NEWS

Long before the internet and instant messaging, fake news was responsible for real events

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ake news is by no means a boundary phenomenon right now. For all we know, it could have gotten a

US President elected and led to a number of hate crimes in our own country, all thanks to technology. However, long before modern technology arrived on the scene, disinformation, or what we know today as fake news, was already making falsified waves on human history.

THE OG FAKESTERS

Traces of ancient rulers propagating fake news about their achievements are spread across history. Rameses The Great did it, Octavian did it to malign Marc Antony, late third century AD Christian apologist Lactantius was guilty of it – the list goes on. The second on that list, Octavian, went on to become Augustus, the first Roman emperor, after successfully spreading slander against Marc Antony through precise, effective slogans printed on the back of coins, not too different from modern-day tweets. Unfortunately, over history, fake news has been used

to target communities, on the basis of religion, nationality, and even political alignment. By the time the medieval ages were done, there had been quite a few instances of hate crimes propelled by fake news between Christians and Jews, often cited as the foundation of anti-Semitism itself. But the true birth of fake news can be triangulated to be around the same time as the birth of the printing press in 1439.

With the printing press, the number of publications increased exponentially, but there were no fixed set of rules or journalistic ethics to be followed. People who were actually looking for the facts had to pay close attention. During this time, the importance of 'leaks' increased, especially when it came to government documents like the Venetian government correspondence. However, faking those wasn't difficult either. By the 17th century, notably around the time of Galileo's trial, historians had begun to cite verifiable sources in their work as the need for fact-checking, especially in the scientific community, increased. This didn't really curb fake news, however. That would be done, to some measure, by the Age of Enlightenment.

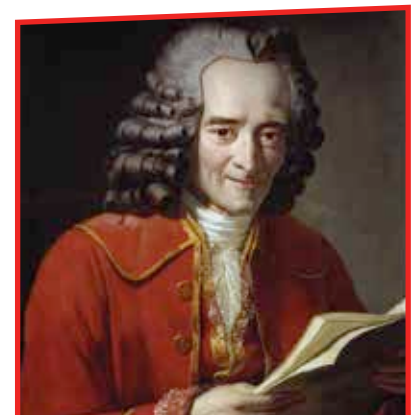
ENLIGHTENMENT AND THE YEARS AFTER

The Great Lisbon earthquake occurred in 1755 and, along with a tsunami and subsequent fires, nearly wiped out Lisbon. Understandably, this was a

sensitive and complex event to cover. As a result, this was another opportunity for religious propaganda – several pamphlets and documents emerged that claimed survivors had seen holy visions. Famed enlightenment philosopher Voltaire took it upon himself to attack religious explanations of natural events and emerged as a staunch critic of fake news itself.

However, his work and the work of others wasn't enough. An easily consumable format, the 'canard' became quite popular in the 18th century. A reportedly popular one (falsely) documented the capture of a monster in Chile that had the "head of a Fury, wings like a bat, a gigantic body covered in scales, and a dragon-like tail". However, not all of the instances were involved merely in harmless sensationalism.

In the years leading up to the French revolution, a deluge of pamphlets found their way to Parisians. These pamphlets, arguably circulated by several political camps opposed to the then ruling monarchy, highlighted the financial mismanagement of the current reign with severely inconsistent numbers and claims. A few popular lots carried the face of Marie Antoinette printed on them and were most likely responsible for fueling public hatred against her leading up to her public execution during the revolution. Similar techniques were used across the ocean in America to justify atrocities against African Americans



Voltaire was an early crusader against fake news